

# THE BEST IS YET TO COME

**\* Denotes power point slide**

**\* Brown denotes instructions to technician**

**INTRO:** Tomorrow we will be celebrating Memorial Day. Memorial Day is a federal holiday observed on the last Monday of May. This holiday was formerly known as Decoration Day and commemorates U.S. soldiers who died while in military service. This holiday was first enacted to honor Union soldiers of the American Civil War, and it was extended after World War I to honor all American soldiers who have died in all wars.

I would like us to have a moment of silence to honor these heroes who paid the ultimate price for our freedom.

On this occasion, I want to expand the scope of our thoughts to include all those who have gone before us.

## **ILLUSTRATION:**

**(As I refer to the pictures in the background on the stage, have the cameras focus in on them)**

The common denominator of every war and all deaths is sin. All problems that we have suffered in our lives have been a direct result of imperfect people who are attempting to live in an imperfect world.

Sin was introduced in the Garden of Eden through the first Adam whose wife's name was Eve. Jesus is the last Adam. Look at the differences between the two:

- The first Adam was created – The last Adam preexisted

- The first Adam was a man and nothing more – The last Adam was God incarnate
- The first Adam sinned – The last Adam atoned sin
- The first Adam bombed out in a paradise – The last Adam didn't sin, even though He was in a difficult wilderness
- The first Adam made us losers – The last Adam made us winners
- The first Adam introduced death into the culture – The last Adam offers abundant and eternal life

The path to overcome sin in this present world is through the last Adam.

## **I. SIN RUINED THE DAY...**

Because of what the first Adam introduced into the world, all of us have experienced more than our fair share of difficulty.

Romans 5:12,18,19 (NKJV) ***“Just as through one man sin entered the world,***

*and death through sin, and thus death spread to all men, because all sinned.*

*<sup>18</sup> Therefore, as through one man's offense judgment came to all men, resulting in condemnation, even so through one Man's righteous act the free gift came to all men, resulting in justification of life. <sup>19</sup> For as by one man's disobedience many were made sinners, so also by one Man's obedience many will be made righteous."*

The first Adam introduced:

- Sin
- Sickness
- Disease
- Poverty

As a result, everyone who has followed the first Adam to planet Earth has experienced some, if not all of these maladies.

For those of us who are following the last Adam I predict: better days are ahead!

## II. JESUS GREATLY IMPROVED THE DAY...

Better days are ahead because God wants you to have abundant life and Jesus paid the price for it. [John 10:10](#) (NKJV) *“The thief does not come except to steal, and to kill, and to destroy. I have come that they may have life, and that they may have it more abundantly.”* The word “*abundantly*” as it is used here comes from the Greek word *perissos* (per-is-sos’) meaning:

- Over and above...
- More than is necessary...
- Something supremely better...
- Extraordinary...
- Preeminent...
- Remarkable...
- Superadded...
- Uncommon...
- Excellent...
- Superior...

To summarize, the abundant life Jesus offers  
- means “*to exceed some number or  
measure or rank or need.*” (Strong's)

If we have made Jesus the top priority in  
life, better days are ahead.

### **SONG:**

Jesus you're the center of my life  
Jesus you're the center of my life  
From beginning to the end  
It will always be - It's always been you  
Jesus

### **III. THE BEST IS YET TO COME...**

The sin of the first Adam ruined the day but  
the sacrifice of the last Adam greatly  
improved the course of history and all of our  
days. As good as life can be there is no way  
to compare the best day here to the worst  
day in heaven.

As we celebrate Memorial Day, we do so with the knowledge that our loved ones are enjoying a day like we have never known.

2 Corinthians 4:17-18 (KJV) *“For our light affliction, which is but for a moment, worketh for us a far more exceeding and eternal weight of glory; <sup>18</sup> While we look not at the things which are seen, but at the things which are not seen: for the things which are seen are temporal; but the things which are not seen are eternal.”*

### **ILLUSTRATION:**

**(Use a scale to talk about the trouble we have all experienced in life – Each time a problem is mentioned - place a dime on one side of a scale that has been displayed – Then talk about the first five minutes in Heaven and place a Kennedy half dollar on the other side of the scale)**

How quickly Heaven will tip the scales.  
Romans 8:18 (KJV) *“I reckon that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which shall be revealed in us.”*

D. L. Moody, the noted preacher of a bygone era, died gloriously declaring, *“This is my coronation day; if this is death, it is sweet.”*

If we have our faith in the last Adam, we are going to experience an eternal day where there will be:

- No more sin... (Ever want to go back and have a do-over?)
- No more sea... (No more separation)
- No more pain... (In this world you will have tribulation)
- No more tears... (All of us have had multiple events that have brought tears to our eyes)

- No more night... (There is no such thing as a night-less day)
- No more death... (No more caskets, funeral homes, hearses, or cemeteries)
- No more sorrow... (The worry lines will be erased from every forehead)
- No more sighing... (Ever been through something so stressful that you realized that you are subconsciously sighing?)

1 Thessalonians 4:16-18 (NKJV) ***“For the Lord Himself will descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of an archangel, and with the trumpet of God. And the dead in Christ will rise first.***

***<sup>17</sup> Then we who are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And thus we shall always be with the Lord.***

***<sup>18</sup> Therefore comfort one another with these words.”***

The teaching of the second coming of our Lord is dealt with some 1,845 times in the Bible; 318 of these are in the New Testament. The return of Jesus is the dominant theme of seventeen Old Testament books and one epistle in the New Testament. Seven out of every ten chapters in the New Testament make reference to the second coming. Whole passages of the last half of the Bible are given over exclusively to its discussion.

S.B. Bangs said, *“The sun is setting; mine is rising. I go from this bed to a crown!”*

1 Corinthians 15:51-54 (NKJV) ***“Behold, I tell you a mystery: We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed—<sup>52</sup> in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound, and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed.<sup>53</sup> For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and***

*this mortal must put on immortality. <sup>54</sup> So when this corruptible has put on incorruption, and this mortal has put on immortality, then shall be brought to pass the saying that is written: “Death is swallowed up in victory.”*

Martha Prior exclaimed, *“The chariot has come and I am ready to step in!”*

**PLACES PREACHED:**

CT Church, Houston, TX 5/26/13